

ART AND CULTURE



RELIGION AND PHILOSOPHY

- **DECLINE OF JAINISM**
- **CHARVAKA SCHOOL**
- **BHAKTI MOVEMENT**

MODULE – 9



CONTRIBUTION OF JAINISM TO INDIAN CULTURE

- 1 Jainism made the first serious attempt to mitigate the evils of the varna order and the ritualistic Vedic religion.
- 2 The early Jainas discarded Sanskrit language mainly patronized by the brahmanas.
- 3 They adopted Prakrit language of the common people to preach their doctrines.
- 4 Their religious literature was written in Ardhamagadhi, and the texts were finally compiled in the sixth century A.D. in Gujarat at a place called Valabhi, a great centre of education.
- 5 The adoption of Prakrit by the Jainas helped the growth of this language and its literature.
- 6 Many regional languages developed out of Prakrit languages, particularly Shauraseni, out of which grew the Marathi language.
- 7 The Jaina literature contains Epics, Puranas, Novels and Drama.
- 8 A large portion of the Jaina writing is still in the form of manuscripts, which have not been published and which are found in the Jaina shrines of Gujarat and Rajasthan.

CONTRIBUTION OF JAINISM TO INDIAN CULTURE

9 In early medieval times, the Jainas also made good use of Sanskrit and wrote many texts in it.

10 Last but not the least, they contributed to the growth of Kannada, in which they wrote extensively.

11 Initially, like the Buddhists, the Jainas were not image worshippers.

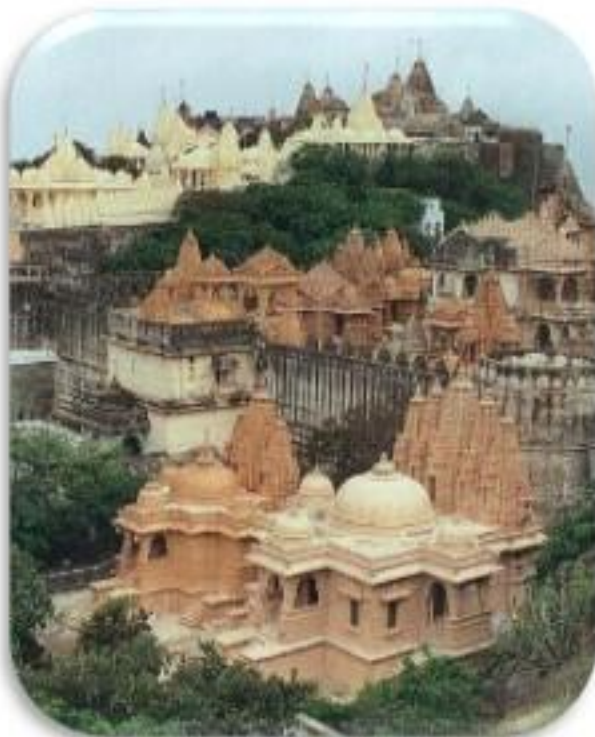
12 Later, they began to worship Mahavira and also the 23 tirthankaras.

13 Beautiful and sometimes massive images in stone were sculpted for this purpose, especially in Karnataka, Gujarat, Rajasthan and Madhya Pradesh.

14 Jaina art in ancient times is not as rich as Buddhists art, but Jainism contributed substantially to art and architecture in medieval times.

JAINISM TEMPLES IN INDIA

A Jain temple, Derasar or Basadi is a place of worship for Jains.



PALITANA TEMPLES



DILWARA JAIN TEMPLES

1

Ancient Jain monuments include:

- the Udaigiri Hills near Bhelsa (Vidisha) in Madhya Pradesh
- the Ellora in Maharashtra
- the Palitana temples in Gujarat, and
- The Dilwara Jain temples near Mount Abu, Rajasthan.

JAINISM TEMPLES IN INDIA

- 2** The Jain complex, Khajuraho and Jain Narayana temple are part of a UNESCO World Heritage Site.



JAIN NARAYANA TEMPLE

- 3** Shravanabelagola, Saavira Kambada Basadi or 1000 pillars and Brahma Jinalaya are important Jain centers in Karnataka.



SHRAVANABELAGOLA

JAINISM TEMPLES IN INDIA



4

- The **Sittanavasal Cave temple** is regarded as one of the finest examples of Jain art.
- It is the oldest and most famous Jain centre in the region.
- It possesses both an **early Jain cave shelter**, and a **medieval rock-cut temple** with excellent **fresco paintings** comparable to Ajantha paintings; the steep hill contains an isolated but spacious cavern.
- Locally, this cavern is known as "**Eladipattam**", a name that is derived from the seven holes cut into the rock that serve as steps leading to the shelter.

REASONS FOR DECLINE OF JAINISM

1 LACK OF ROYAL PATRONAGE

- The royal patronage of Jainism by Bimbisara, Ajatasatru, Udayin and Kharavela was not kept up by kings and princes of later times.
- Rather the zeal and determination of Asoka, Kanishka and Harsha led to spread of Buddhism while Jainism came to an end.
- As such, lack of sincere and determined royal patronage came to cease Jainism.

2 SEVERITY OF JAINISM

- The severity of Jainism is also responsible for its gradual decline.
- Unlike the 'middle path' of Buddhism, Jainism stood for severe penance, meditation, fasting and restraint etc.
- All these were too severe to endure. People soon became disillusioned with it.
- In course of time, Jainism, once adored, became alienated from the people.

REASONS FOR DECLINE OF JAINISM

3 UNINTELLIGIBLE PHILOSOPHY

- Most of the Jaina philosophy was **unintelligible** for the masses.
- The **concepts of Jeeva, Ajeeva, Pudgala**, etc. could not be understood properly by the people.
- Many could not accept the view that **stone, water, tree or earth had a soul of their own**.
- There was, thus, a gradual decline in popular faith for Jainism. This paved the way for its decline.

4 DIVISION IN JAINISM

- This was another important reason for the decline of Jainism.
- Some now advocated to literally follow the teachings of Mahavira, while others wanted to dilute the severity of Jainism.
- As such they got divided into '**Digambara**' and '**Swetambara**' groups.
- The former, led by Bhadrabahu, gave up dress, **adopted severe penance** for self-purification and became indifferent to worldly life. The 'Swetambara' group, led by Stalabahu, **wore white dress**.
- The division weakened Jainism and gradually led to its decline.

SIMILARITIES BETWEEN JAINISM AND BUDDHISM

- 1 Both Jainism and Buddhism had a similarity of ideas and both have sprung up almost in the same circumstances/ situations.
- 2 Both appeared as revolts against orthodox Brahmanical Hinduism.
- 3 Both Buddhism and Jainism sprang in Eastern India where the Aryan culture had no sweeping influence.
- 4 They contributed to the rise of the revolutionary anti-Brahmanical creeds of Buddhism and Jainism in Eastern India.
- 5 In respect of their basic philosophical concepts, Buddhism and Jainism were indebted to the Samkhya philosophy.
- 6 The Buddhists and Jainas equally believe that the world is full of misery, that the objective of religion is to liberate self from the miseries of this world by eliminating rebirth.
- 7 This concept of the Jainas and the Buddhists that world is a misery and that man is subjected to the result of Karma was borrowed from the Upanishadas and the Samkhya philosophy.

SIMILARITIES BETWEEN JAINISM AND BUDDHISM



- 8** Both Mahavira and Buddha rejected the authority of the Vedas and the efficacy of Vedic rites.

- 9** Both upheld ascetic life, moral and ethical codes.

- 10** Both the teachers upheld non-violence as means of salvation.

- 11** Jainism and Buddhism had largest number of followers among the mercantile class.

- 12** Both Mahavira and Buddha preached their doctrines in the language of the people.

BASIC DISSIMILARITIES

	JAINISM	BUDDHISM
<i>Founded on</i>	The teachings of 24 Tirthankaras including Vardhamana Mahavira	The teachings of Gautama Buddha
<i>Main sects</i>	Digambara, Svetambara	Mahayana and Hinayana
<i>Concept about soul</i>	Believes that soul is a living entity which sticks to different types of matter.	They do not believe in the ideas of eternal self or soul (Atman) and eternity.
<i>Doctrines</i>	Non-violence, not lying, not stealing, celibacy, non-possession	Eight-fold path
<i>Way to liberation</i>	Rigorous asceticism and self- mortification	Middle Path (through ashtangika marga)
<i>Progress</i>	Mainly confined to India	Spread to other parts of world

CHARVAKA SCHOOL OR LOKAYATA PHILOSOPHY

- 1 Cārvāka and Ajita Kesakambalin are said to have established Indian Materialism as a formal philosophical system, but some hold that Brīhaspati was its original founder.
- 2 Brīhaspati allegedly authored the classic work on Indian Materialism, the Brīhaspati Sutra.
- 3 The Charvaka School was the main propounder of the materialistic view.
- 4 As it was geared towards the common people, the philosophy was soon dubbed as Lokayata or something derived from the common people.
- 5 The word 'Lokayata' also meant a keen attachment to the physical and material world (loka).
- 6 They argued for a complete disregard of any world beyond this world that was inhabited by a person.
- 7 They denied the existence of any supernatural or divine agent who could regulate our conduct on earth.
- 8 They argued against the need to achieve salvation and also denied the existence of brahma and God.
- 9 They believed in anything that could be touched and be experienced by the human senses.

CHARVAKA SCHOOL OR LOKAYATA PHILOSOPHY

10 *Some of their main teachings are:*

- They **argued against Gods** and their representatives on the earth – the **priestly class**. They argued that a Brahman manufactures false rituals so as to acquire gifts (dakshina) from the followers.
- **Man is the centre** of all activities and he should enjoy himself as long as he lives. He should consume all earthly goods and **indulge in sensual pleasure**.
- The Charvakas **do not consider 'ether'** as one of the five essential elements of earth as it cannot be experienced through the perception hence, they say the universe consists of only four elements: fire, earth, water and air.
- This school argues that there is **no other world after this one**, hence death is the end of a human being and **pleasure should be ultimate objective** of life. Hence they propound the theory of 'eat, drink and make merry'.

CHARVAKA SCHOOL OR LOKAYATA PHILOSOPHY

10 *Some of their main teachings are (contd..):*

- Cārvākas were, in a sense, one of the **first philosophical pragmatists**.
- The Cārvākas **denied philosophical claims** that could not be verified through direct experience. However, **logical inferences** that were made based on premises that were derived from direct experience were held as valid.
- The common example used to demonstrate the difference is the inference that if smoke is rising from a building it is probably an indication that there is a fire within the building.

CHARVAKA SCHOOL OR LOKAYATA PHILOSOPHY

10 *Some of their main teachings are (contd..):*

- There is also **no doctrine of Creation** in the Lokāyata.
- The **principles of karma (action) and niyati (fate)** are rejected because they are derived from the notion that existence in itself is purposeful.
- Thus, Materialism in its original form was essentially **anti-Vedic**.
- It rejects ethical systems that are grounded in **supernaturalistic cosmologies**. The good, for the Indian materialist, is strictly associated with **pleasure** and the **only ethical obligation** forwarded by the system is the **maximization of one's own pleasure**.

THE BHAKTI MOVEMENT

The Bhakti movement emerged as a new devotional trend in the Hindu society

1 It aimed to purge the religion of its Brahmanical orthodoxy, evils like untouchability, and loosen the grip of the caste system.

2 Its tenets were based on devotion on God and equality of mankind.

3 The movement had its origin in the 8th century CE when the Alvars (Vaishnavites) and the Nayanars (Shaivites) had emerged in Southern India.



THE BHAKTI MOVEMENT

4 The movement reached its zenith in the 15th and 16th century and is referred to as the Bhakti movement.

5 The Bhakti movement emerged in Northern and Eastern India much later.

6 Further, here it manifested in different sects which were based on worship of different deities such as Vaishnavism, Shaivism, Shaktism, etc.

REASONS FOR EMERGENCE OF THE BHAKTI MOVEMENT



- 1 The period of the 6th century CE onwards saw a varied influence on the Hindu religious thoughts.

- 2 The Vedic traditions had started to give way to the **Puranic culture**.
- 3 The Brahmanical ideas were getting disseminated in the society and at the same time **local beliefs and practices** were also influencing the broader Hindu thought.
- 4 The influence of Buddhism and Jainism had **started to stagnate** and even decline.
- 5 Amidst all the turbulence in society, there was emergence of the Bhakti movement which emphasized on **devotion to God and reform of the religious belief and practices**.

REASONS FOR EMERGENCE OF THE BHAKTI MOVEMENT

The key reasons for the growth of Bhakti movement are summarized as below:

RESPONSE TO THE BRAHMANICAL ORTHODOXY

- 1** The Bhakti movement was partly a response to the Brahmanical orthodoxy and rigidity in the caste system.
- 2** It provided an **inclusive platform to the marginalized sections of society** due to its emphasis on equality of mankind.
- 3** It provided scope for **salvation to all including women, artisans, weavers, cultivators, and untouchables**.
- 4** Thus, it appealed to a large underprivileged section of society where it gained popularity and emerged as a religious thought.

REASONS FOR EMERGENCE OF THE BHAKTI MOVEMENT

DECLINE IN BUDDHISM AND JAINISM

5

- The stagnation and decline in Buddhism and Jainism owing to **pollution in their own thought** (viz. emergence of tantric Buddhism -Vajrayana, etc.) led to disenchantment of masses from them.
- This enabled the emergence of a **new religious thought based on devotion**.

POLITICAL PATRONAGE

6

- **Political patronage** was another factor helping in its growth, (e.g., the support of **Chola kings in Tamil Nadu to the Shaivite movement**).
- While these movements sought the royal support for seeking land grants for construction of temples etc., the support of royalty to these movements helped the dynasties to be perceived as spiritual and religious.
- At times, they were also keen to seek the support of the eminent saints associated with the movement.

WE EXPRESS OUR
SINCERE THANKS
FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

Presented by



Learning Space

For Suggestions:

suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

OUR TEAM

G. V. Rao

K. Srikanth

D. Sunil Kumar

L. V. Krishna

Y. Deepthi

Amrita Naidu

M. Binukrishna

G. Ravi Babu

D. Joji

K. Victor Babu

Visit us at:

www.learningspacedigital.com

0 8 6 6 -2 4 4 4 4 7 2

0 9 8 4 9 9 4 2 2 9 9